KDL OS

From clone to a working Web App and Landing Page

A step-by-step guide for a new install on your own computer

Covers	Clone, setup, first login, company details, Web App, Landing Page, publish
Time needed	About 30 minutes (most of it is the first build)
You need	Git, Docker Desktop, OpenSSL. No accounts or API keys.
Checked against	The running KDL OS app, screens as of November 2026

The big picture

Setting up has four parts. Do them in this order.

Part	What you do	Result
1 Install	Clone the code, create the settings file, start Docker, create the admin user	KDL OS runs at http://localhost
2 Set up	Sign in, answer the Setup Wizard (company, logo, what you are building)	Your company details and products are saved
3 Web App	Frontend → Brands → Web app: fonts, buttons, menu, pages, layouts	A branded multi-page website
4 Landing Page	Frontend → Brands → Landing Pages: pick a template, edit, publish	A live page at /p/your-name

> **Good to know:** The company name, logo and contact details are entered **once** (Part 2). The Web App, every Landing Page and the footers all read them from there. You never type them again.

Part 1. Install

Step 1. Install three tools

Tool	Get it from	Check
Git	git-scm.com	`git --version`
Docker Desktop	docker.com/products/docker-desktop	`docker --version`
OpenSSL	Already on Mac and Linux	`openssl version`

Start Docker Desktop and wait until it says **running**. Give it enough memory: Docker Desktop → Settings → Resources → Memory → **8 GB**.

> **Important:** Windows: do the Windows (WSL) setup in `docs/INSTALLATION_GUIDE_SIMPLE.md` first, then type every command in the Ubuntu window.

Step 2. Clone the code

```
git clone https://github.com/F9info/kdl-os.git
cd kdl-os
```

Stay inside the `kdl-os` folder for all the next steps.

Step 3. Create the settings file (.env)

Paste this whole block into the terminal. It creates `.env` with new random passwords.

```
PG_PASS=$(openssl rand -hex 16)
REDIS_PASS=$(openssl rand -hex 16)
MINIO_PASS=$(openssl rand -hex 16)

cat > .env <<EOF
NODE_ENV=development
APP_PORT=4000
FRONTEND_URL=http://localhost
BACKEND_URL=http://localhost:4000
AI_SERVICES_URL=http://localhost:5000
CORS_ORIGIN=http://localhost,http://localhost:3000,http://localhost:3001
JWT_SECRET=$(openssl rand -hex 32)
JWT_REFRESH_SECRET=$(openssl rand -hex 32)
JWT_EXPIRES_IN=15m
JWT_REFRESH_EXPIRES_IN=7d
APP_ENCRYPTION_KEY=$(openssl rand -hex 32)
POSTGRES_USER=postgres
POSTGRES_PASSWORD=$PG_PASS
POSTGRES_DB=kdl_db
DATABASE_URL=postgresql://postgres:$PG_PASS@localhost:5433/kdl_db
REDIS_PASSWORD=$REDIS_PASS
REDIS_URL=redis://:$REDIS_PASS@localhost:6380
MINIO_ROOT_USER=kdl_minio
MINIO_ROOT_PASSWORD=$MINIO_PASS
MINIO_ACCESS_KEY=kdl_minio
MINIO_SECRET_KEY=$MINIO_PASS
MINIO_ENDPOINT=localhost
MINIO_PORT=9000
MINIO_USE_SSL=false
MINIO_BUCKET=kdl-media
MEILISEARCH_HOST=http://localhost:7700
MEILI_MASTER_KEY=$(openssl rand -hex 24)
MEILISEARCH_API_KEY=replace-after-first-boot
MEILI_SEARCH_API_KEY=replace-after-first-boot
CHROMADB_URL=http://localhost:8000
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=local
OPENROUTER_API_KEY=local
EOF
chmod 600 .env
```

> **Important:** Never share or upload `.env`. It holds your passwords. The AI keys can stay as `local`: the Web App and Landing Pages do not need them.

Step 4. Start KDL OS

```
docker compose up -d --build
docker compose ps
```

The first build takes **10 to 20 minutes**. Later starts take seconds. Wait until `backend` says **healthy** (about 1 minute after the build).

Step 5. Create the admin user

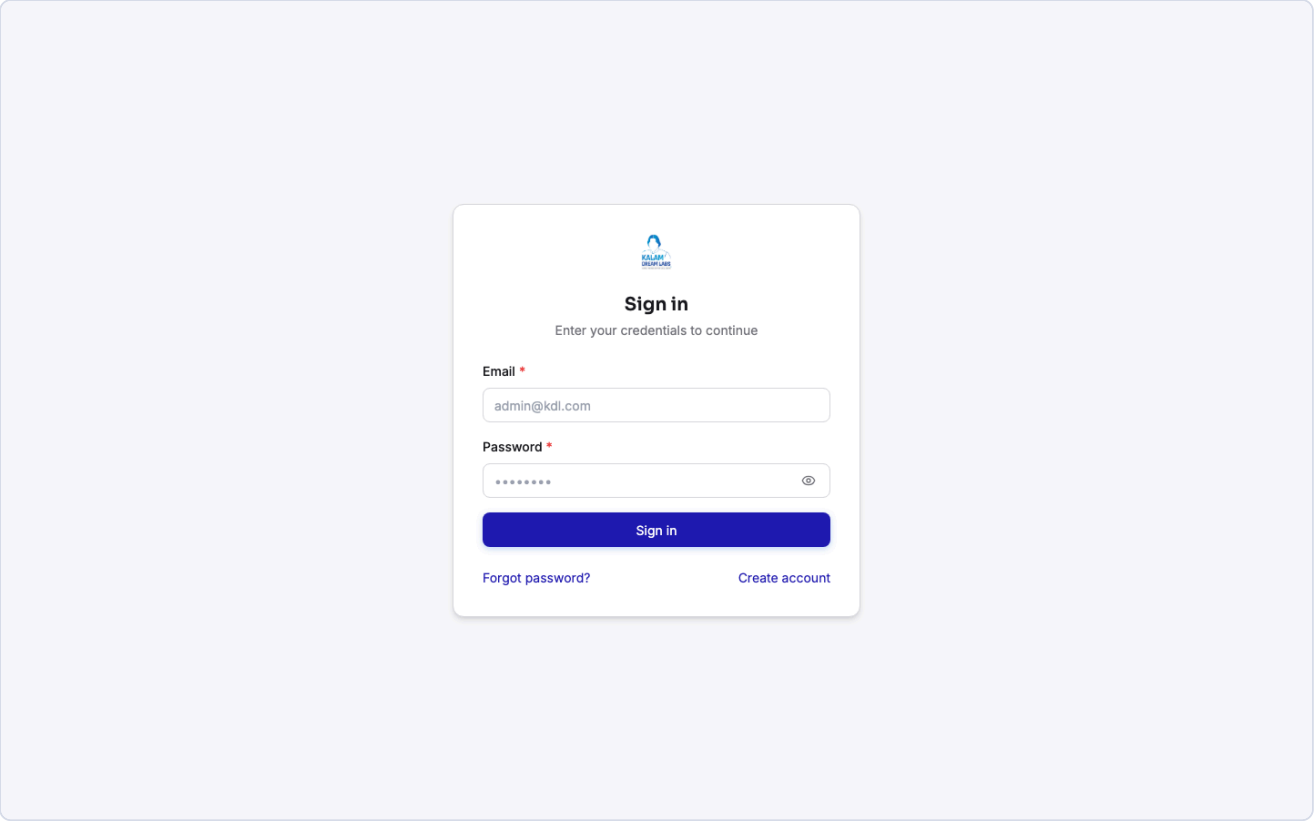
```
docker compose exec backend node prisma/seed.js
```

You should see `Seeded admin: admin@kdl.com`. Run this once.

Part 2. First login and company setup

Step 6. Sign in

1. Open **http://localhost/login** in your browser.
2. Email: `admin@kdl.com`. Password: `kdl-dev-seed-password`.
3. KDL OS asks you to choose a new password. Do it and remember it.

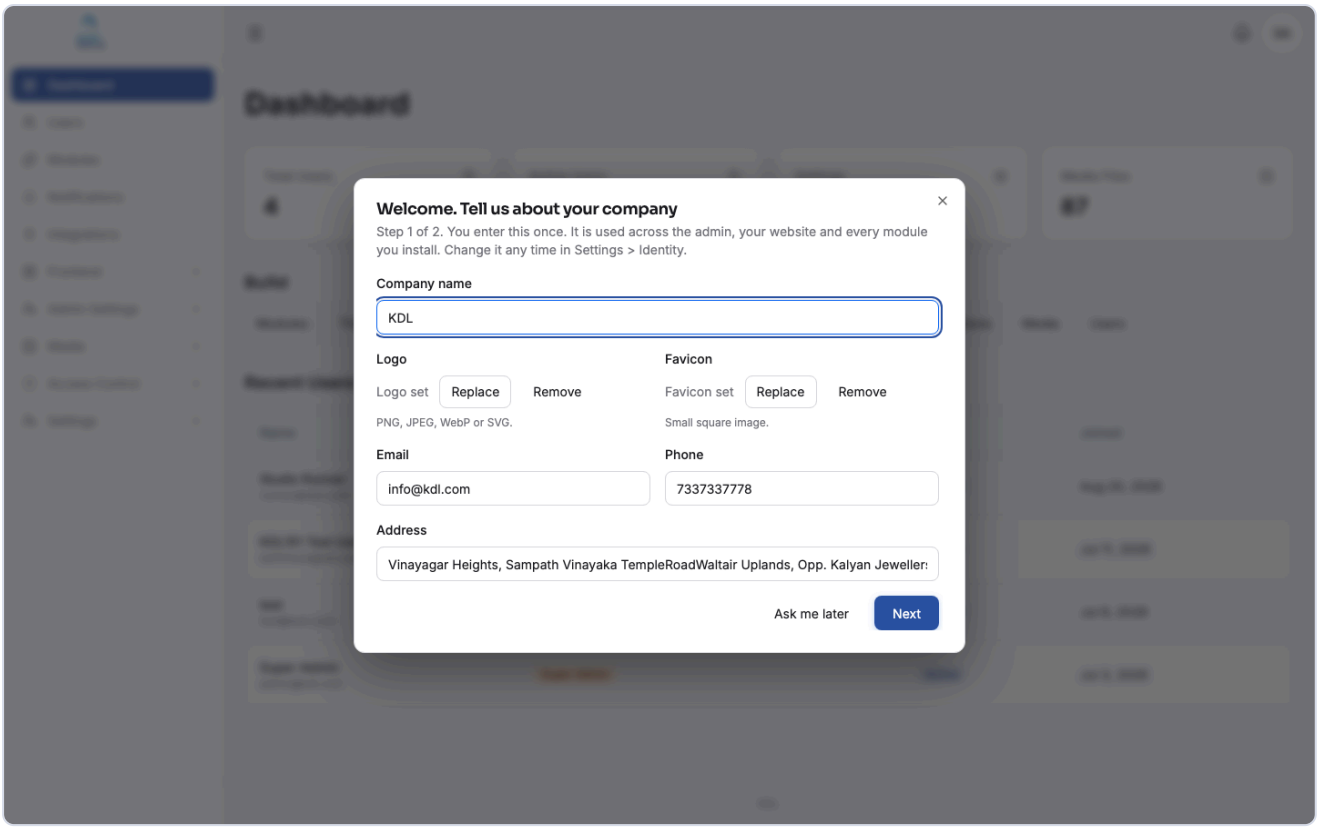


The sign-in page.

Step 7. Answer the Setup Wizard

The first time you reach the dashboard, a three-step wizard opens by itself.

1. **Step 1 of 2: "Welcome. Tell us about your company".** Enter the company name, logo, favicon, email, phone and address. Click **Next**.
2. **Step 2 of 2: "What are you building?".** Turn on **Website** (this is the Web App) and/or **Landing Pages**. Tick both for this guide. Click **Next**. Admin is always on.
3. **"Create a starter website?"** (shown only if Website is on). Choose **Yes, create my website** to get a ready 5-page site: Home, About, Services, Contact, FAQ. Choose **Skip** to start with no pages.
4. **"You are set up".** Click **Done**.



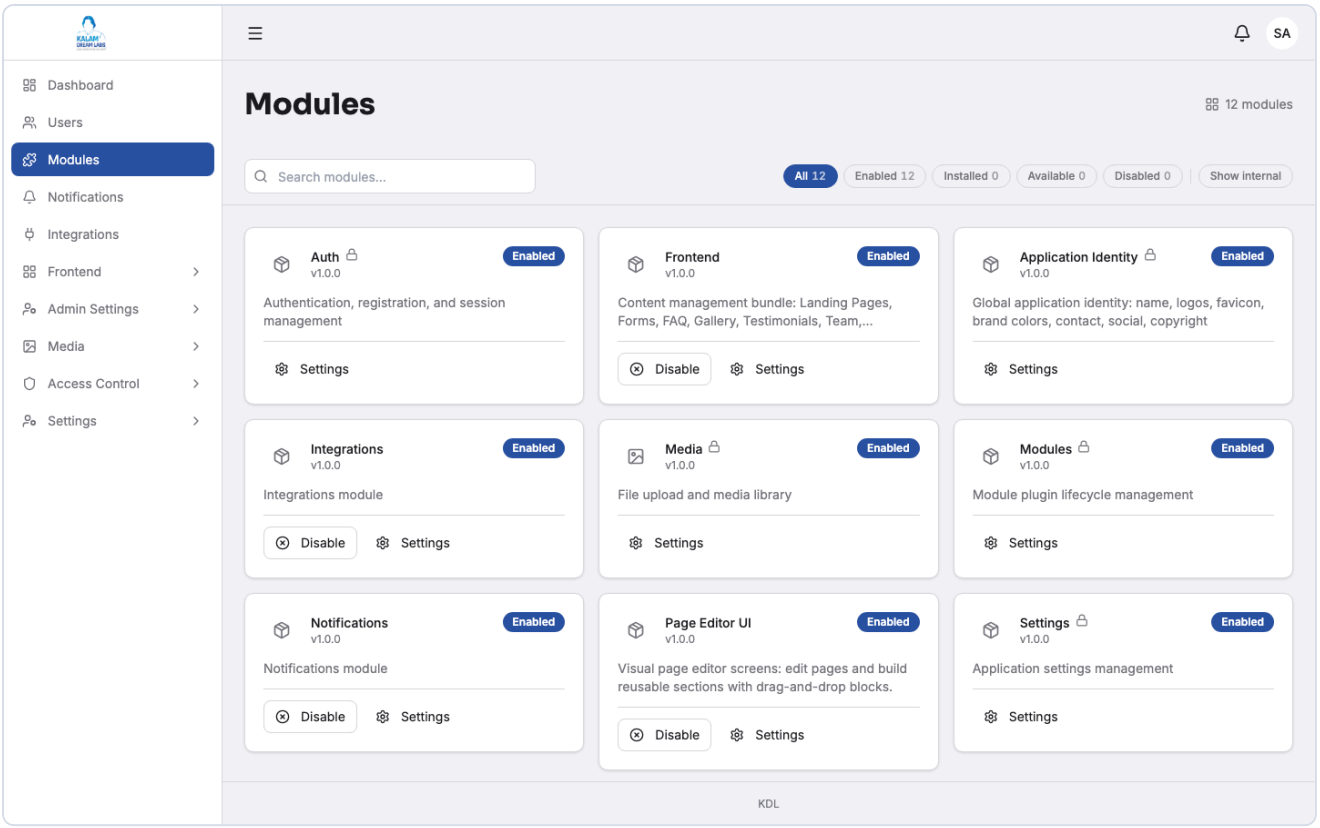
Wizard step 1: your company details.

> **Important: Add the logo now.** The Color Palette, Brands, Navigation, Layouts and Pages screens are all built from your logo. Without one, they show "Add your logo and company details first" and send you to Settings → Identity.

> **Good to know:** If you click **Ask me later**, the wizard stays closed in that browser. You can still choose your products later at `http://localhost/admin/settings/products` (no menu link) and edit company details at **Admin Settings** → **Identity**.

Step 8. Check that the Frontend module is on

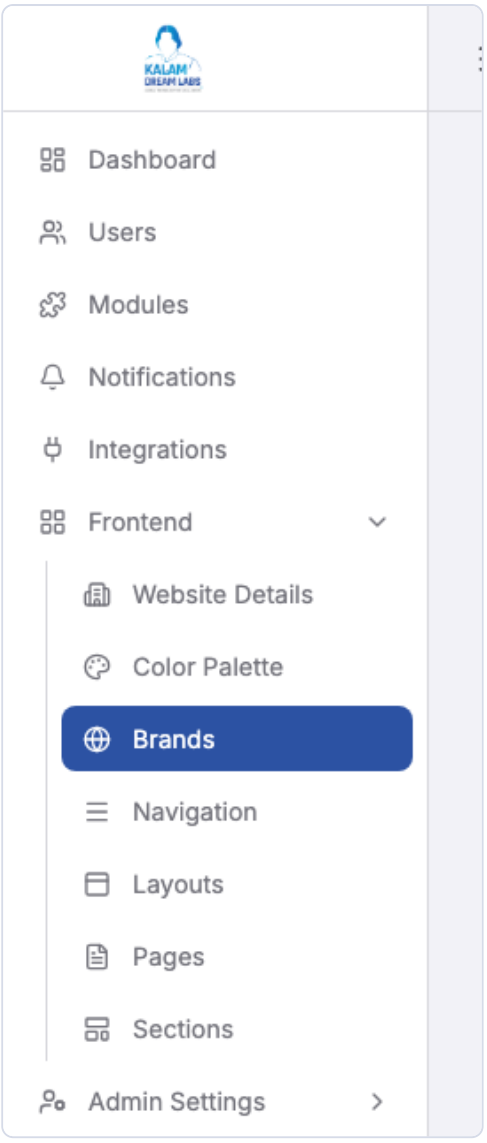
Open **Modules**. The module called **Frontend** (the content bundle: Landing Pages, Forms, FAQ, Gallery, Team, Menus and more) must say **Enabled**. Choosing Website or Landing Pages in the wizard enables it. If it shows **Install** or **Enable**, click it.



Modules: Frontend is enabled.

The sidebar now has a **Frontend** group. Its items, in the order you use them:

Menu item	What it is for
Website Details	Shows your company details (edited in Identity) and the website text
Color Palette	Colours made from your logo
Brands	The cards that open the Web app, Landing Pages and Collateral
Navigation	The menu: which pages appear in the header and footer
Layouts	Header, top bar and footer designs
Pages	One card per page, with an Edit button
Sections	Saved sections you can reuse on many pages



The Frontend group in the sidebar.

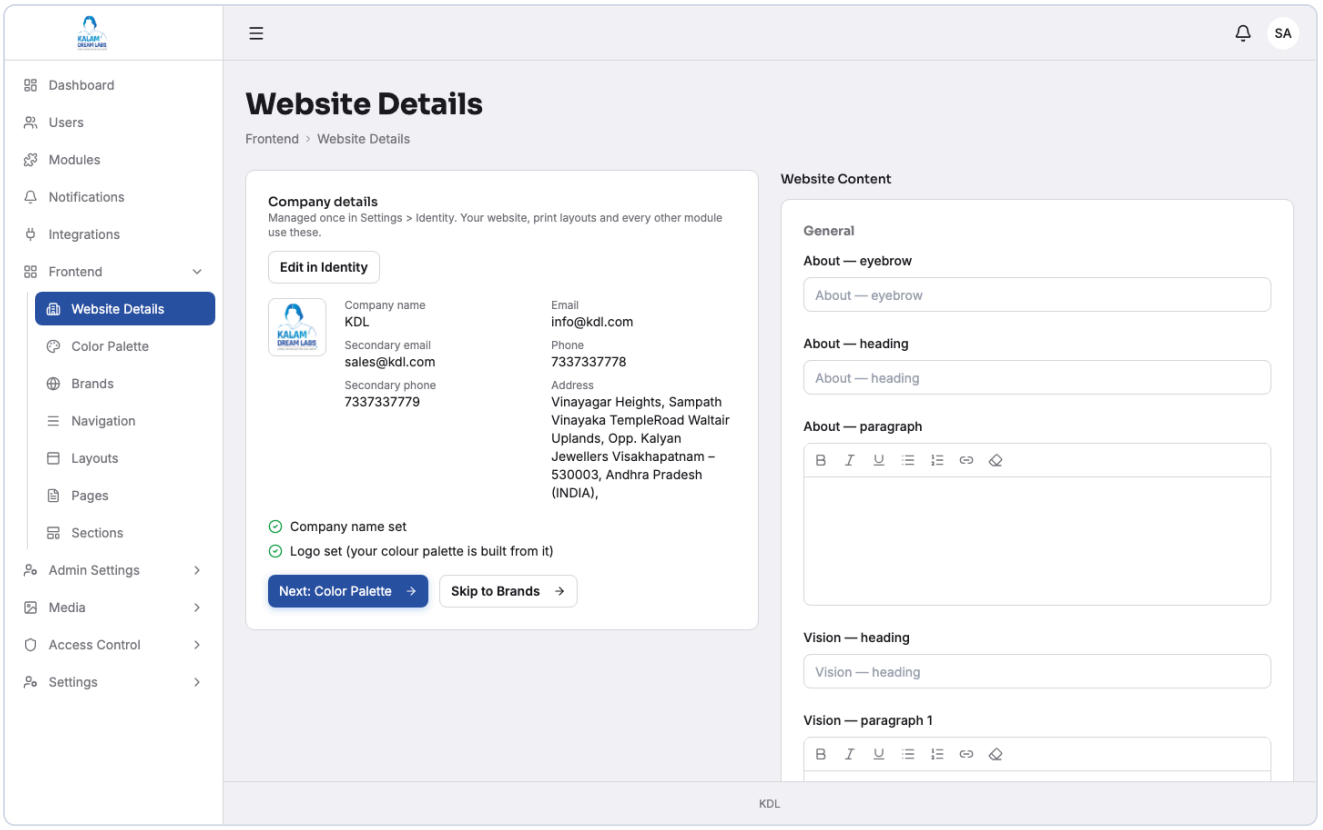
Company details and branding live under **Admin Settings**: **Identity**, **SEO** and **Themes**.

Part 3. Create the Web App

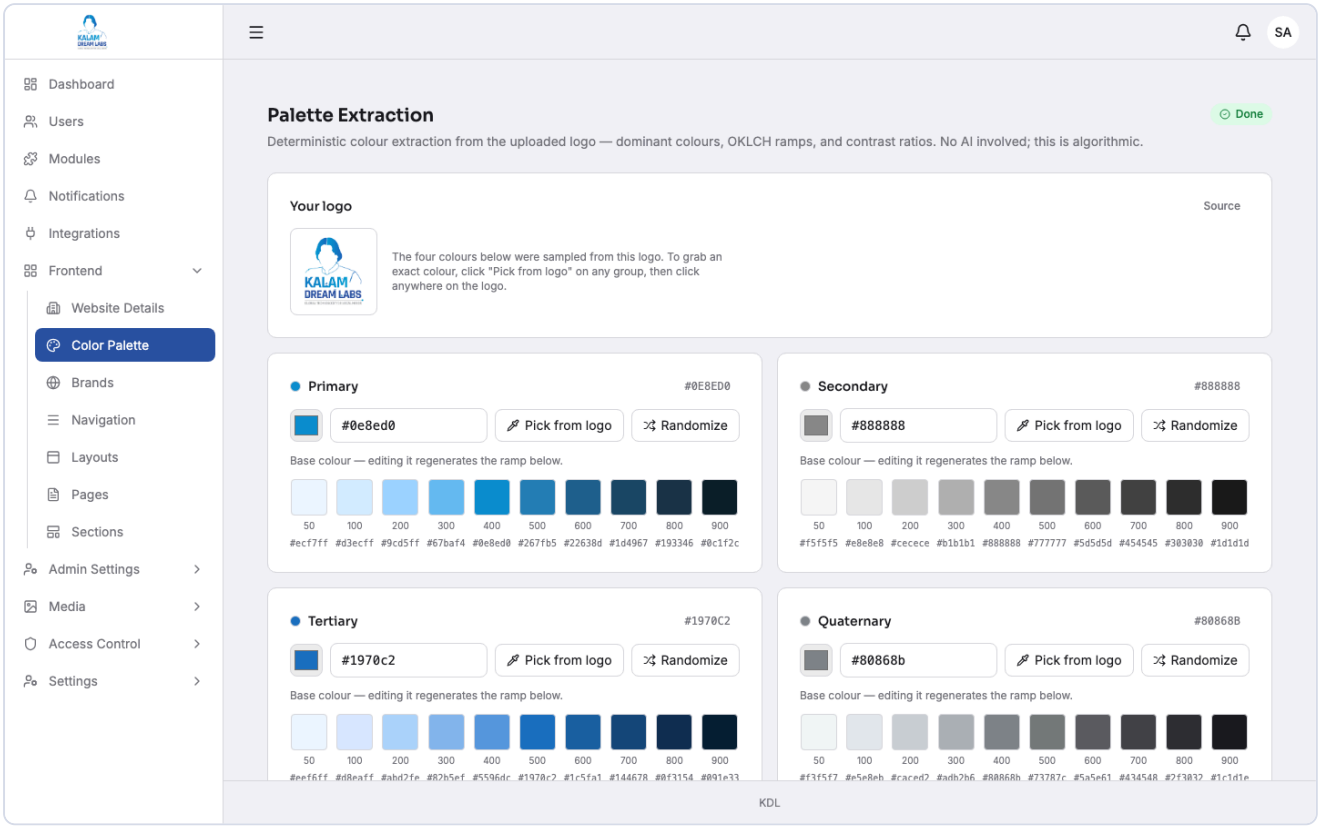
A Web App is a multi-page website. You build it in one guided flow. You can leave and come back at any time: your place in the flow is remembered.

Step 9. Check your company details and colours

1. Open **Frontend** → **Website Details**. Check the company name, email, phone and address. To change them, click **Edit in Identity**. Then click **Next: Color Palette**.
2. On the Color Palette screen, the primary and secondary colours are taken from your logo. To pick an exact colour, click **Pick from logo**, then click the logo. **Randomize** gives new colours. If you do not need to set colours, use **Skip to Brands**.



Website Details: your company details and the Next / Skip buttons.

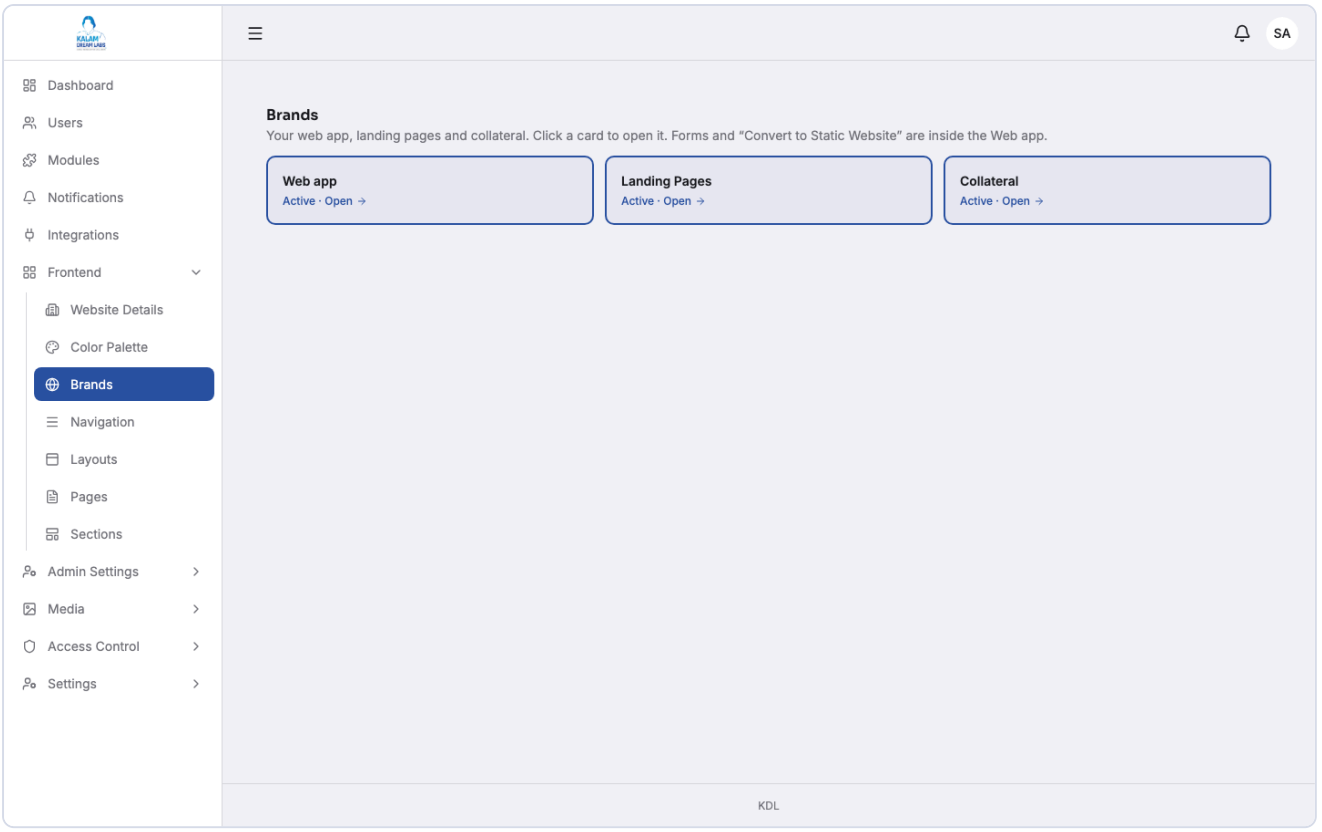


Color Palette: colours sampled from your logo.

Step 10. Open the Web app

1. Open **Frontend → Brands.**

2. Click the **Web app** card. It opens the guided flow. **Forms** and **Convert to Static Website** are inside it, at the top.

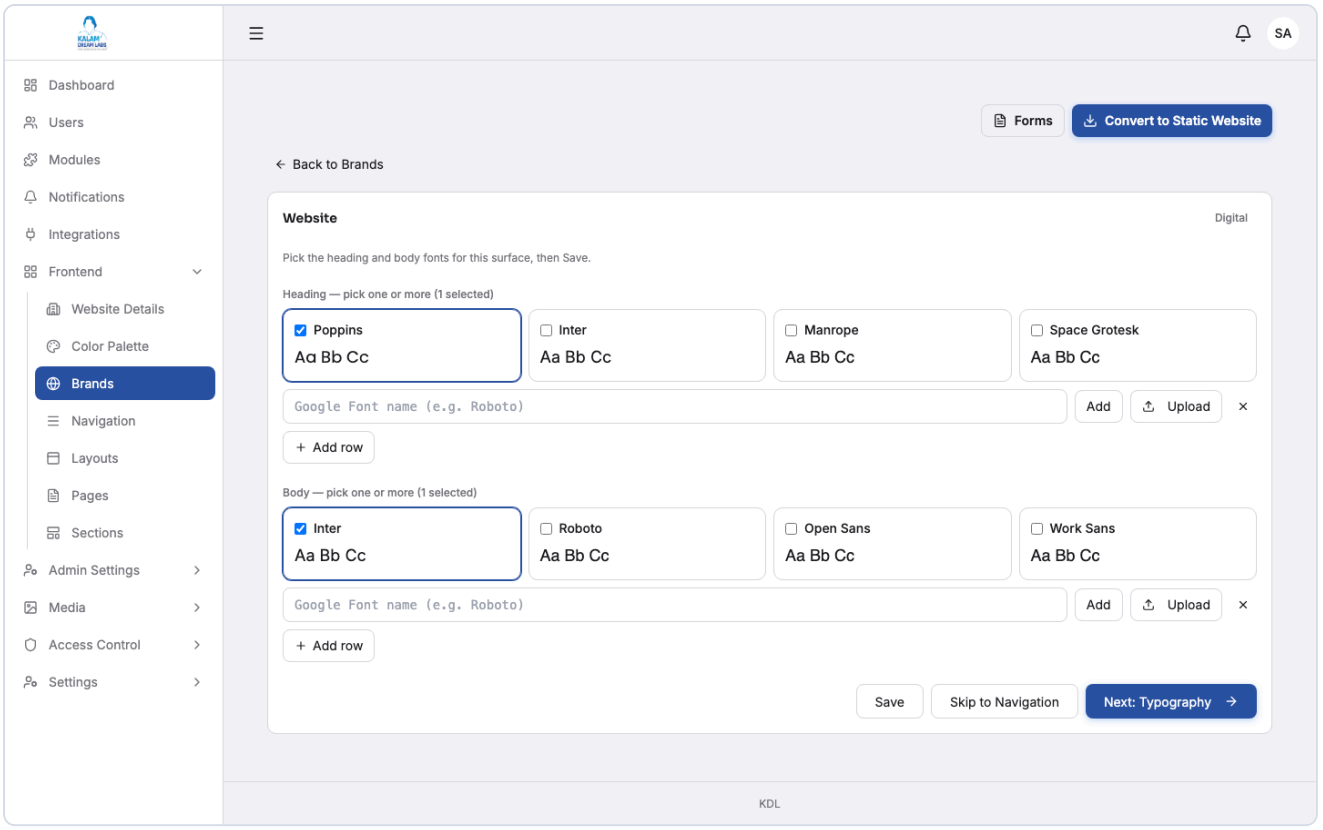


Brands: Web app, Landing Pages and Collateral.

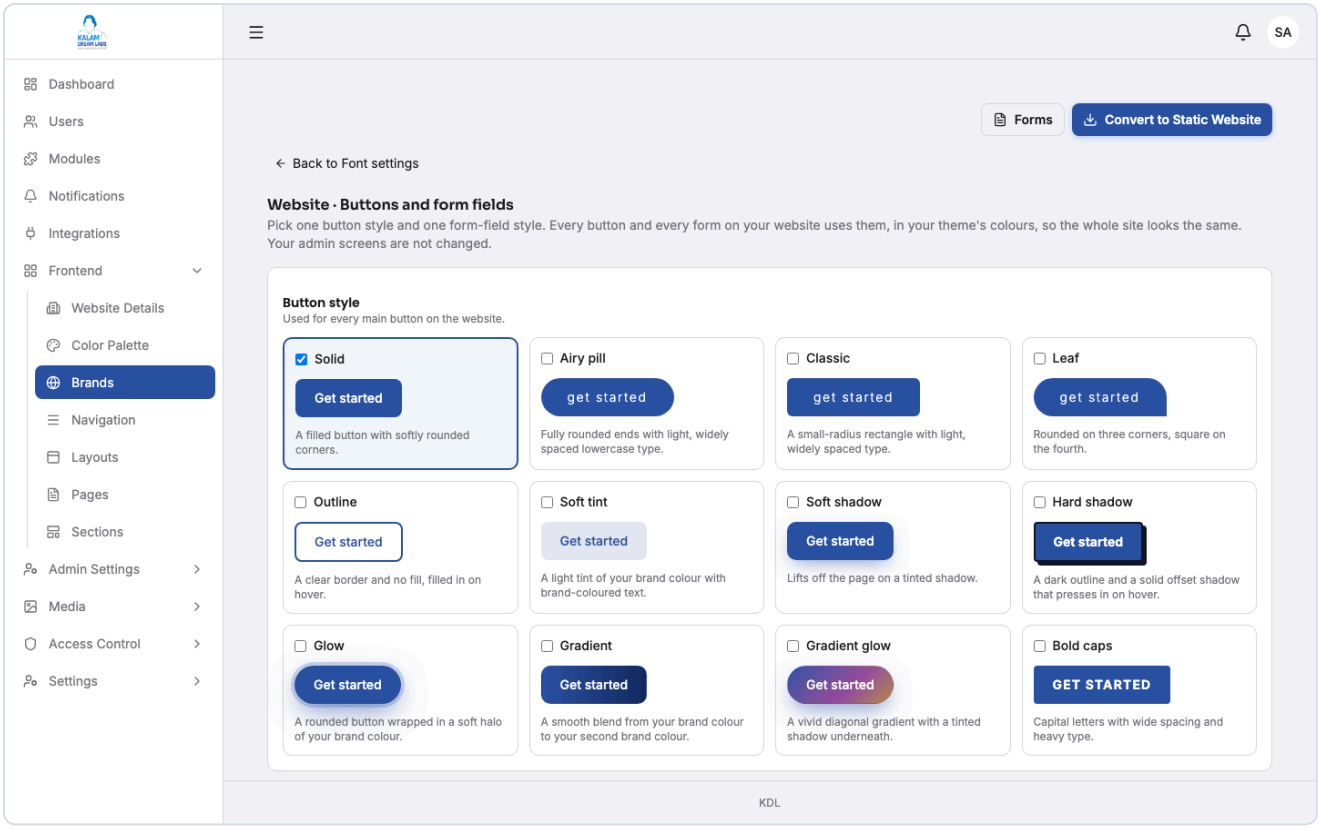
Step 11. Walk through the flow

The flow has these steps. Each has **Back** and a button to move on.

#	Step	What you do	Buttons
1	Typography	Pick the heading font and the body font from the lists, or add your own.	Save, Skip to Navigation, Next: Typography (opens Font settings)
2	Font settings	Fine-tune sizes, weights and spacing for headings and text.	Save, Skip to Navigation, Next: Buttons and form fields
3	Buttons and form fields	Pick **one** button style (12 choices, including gradient and shadow) and **one** form-field style (8 choices). Your whole website uses them.	Save, Next: Navigation
4	Navigation	Choose the menu items. See Step 12.	Skip to Layouts, Next: Pages
5	Pages	One card per menu item, plus Home. Click **Edit** to open a page in the editor.	Complete
6	Layouts	Pick header, top bar and footer designs for every page.	-



Typography: pick your fonts.

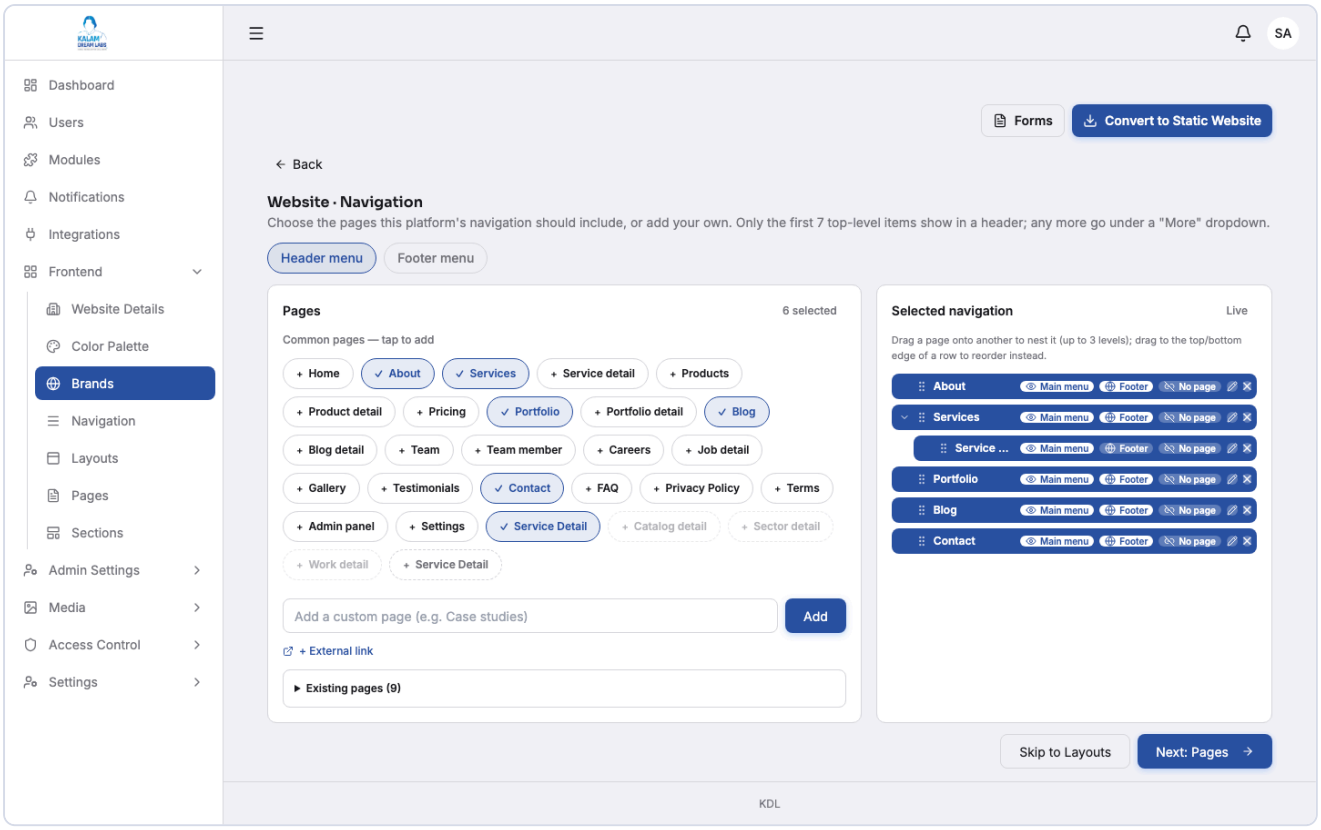


Buttons and form fields: one style for the whole website.

Step 12. Set up the navigation

1. In **Header menu**, click the page names you want as chips (Home, About, Services, Pricing, Portfolio, Blog and more). A tick means it is already in the menu. You can also add your own page name.

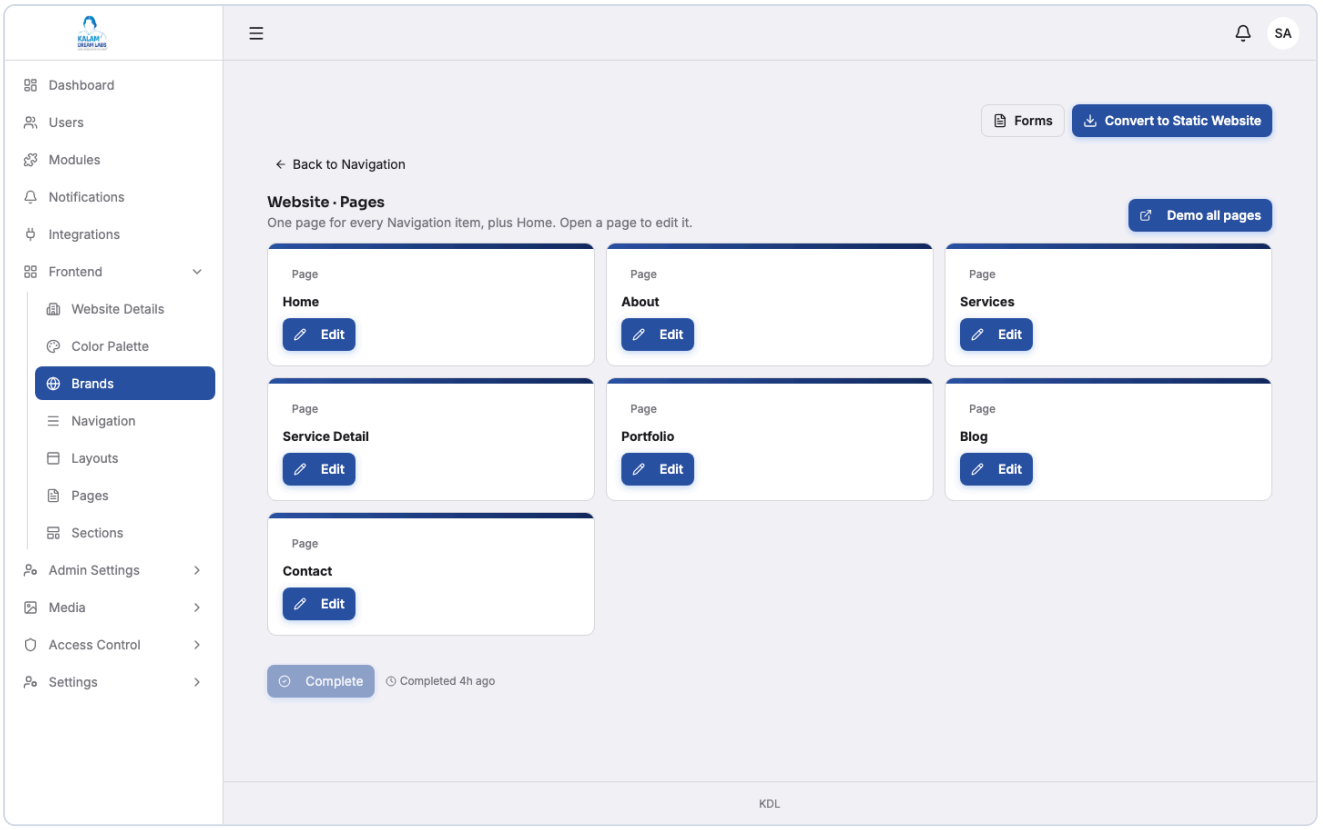
2. Drag items to change their order. Use **Footer menu** to set the footer links, or switch on "Use the same links as the header menu".
3. Only the first 7 top-level items show in the header. Any more go under a **More** dropdown.
4. Click **Next: Pages**. This builds a page for every menu item you chose.



Navigation: pick the pages, drag to reorder.

Step 13. Review and edit your pages

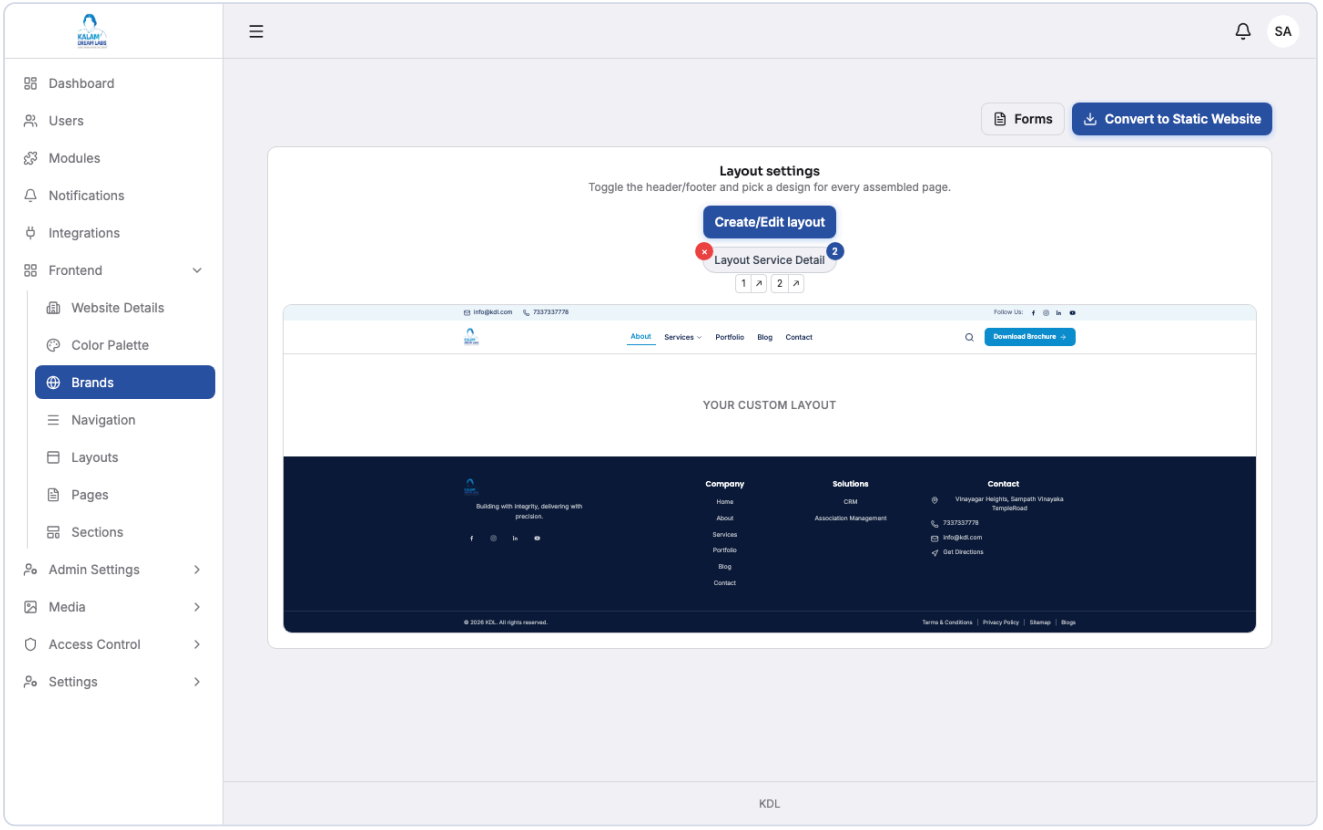
1. On the Pages step, you see Home and one card for every menu item. The list always matches Navigation.
2. Click **Edit** on a card. The page opens in the editor in a new tab. Use **Insert block** to add sections, click a section to change its text, images and links, and pick a different **Design** for a section.
3. Click **Publish**. The checks run first (empty page, missing title, broken link). Fix any problem, or choose **Publish anyway**.
4. Your site is live. Open **http://localhost** to see it.



Pages: one card for every menu item.

Step 14. Set the header and footer

Open **Frontend** → **Layouts** (or the Layouts step). Switch the top bar, header and footer on or off and pick a design. The change applies to every page.



Layouts: header, top bar and footer designs.

Optional. Convert the Web App to a static website

A static website is a plain folder of files you can put on any web host.

1. In the Web app flow, click **Convert to Static Website** at the top.
2. Click the one conversion button and wait. The folder is created at `frontend/projects/<your-project>/out`, and a .zip is offered for download.
3. Upload the folder to the **root** of a domain. After you change your site, click **Convert again**.

> **Good to know:** The forms on a static site cannot send mail by themselves. The contact block shows your contact details instead, unless you give a Web app address in the conversion screen.

Part 4. Create a Landing Page

A Landing Page is one focused page with one clear action, such as a sign-up form. It has no site menu. Its footer shows your company details from Identity.

Step 15. Open Landing Pages

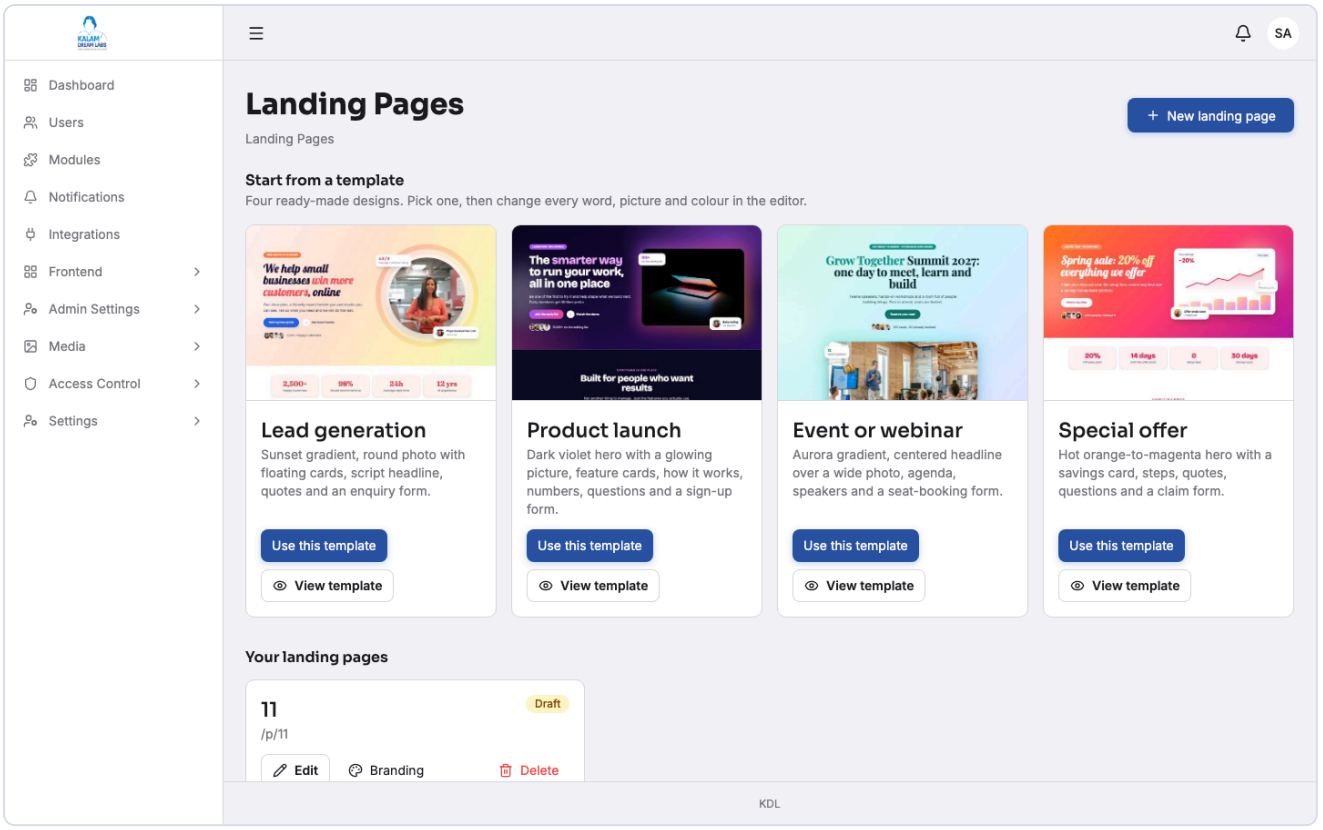
Open **Frontend** → **Brands** and click **Landing Pages**. (Direct address: `http://localhost/admin/landing-pages`.)

Step 16. Choose a template

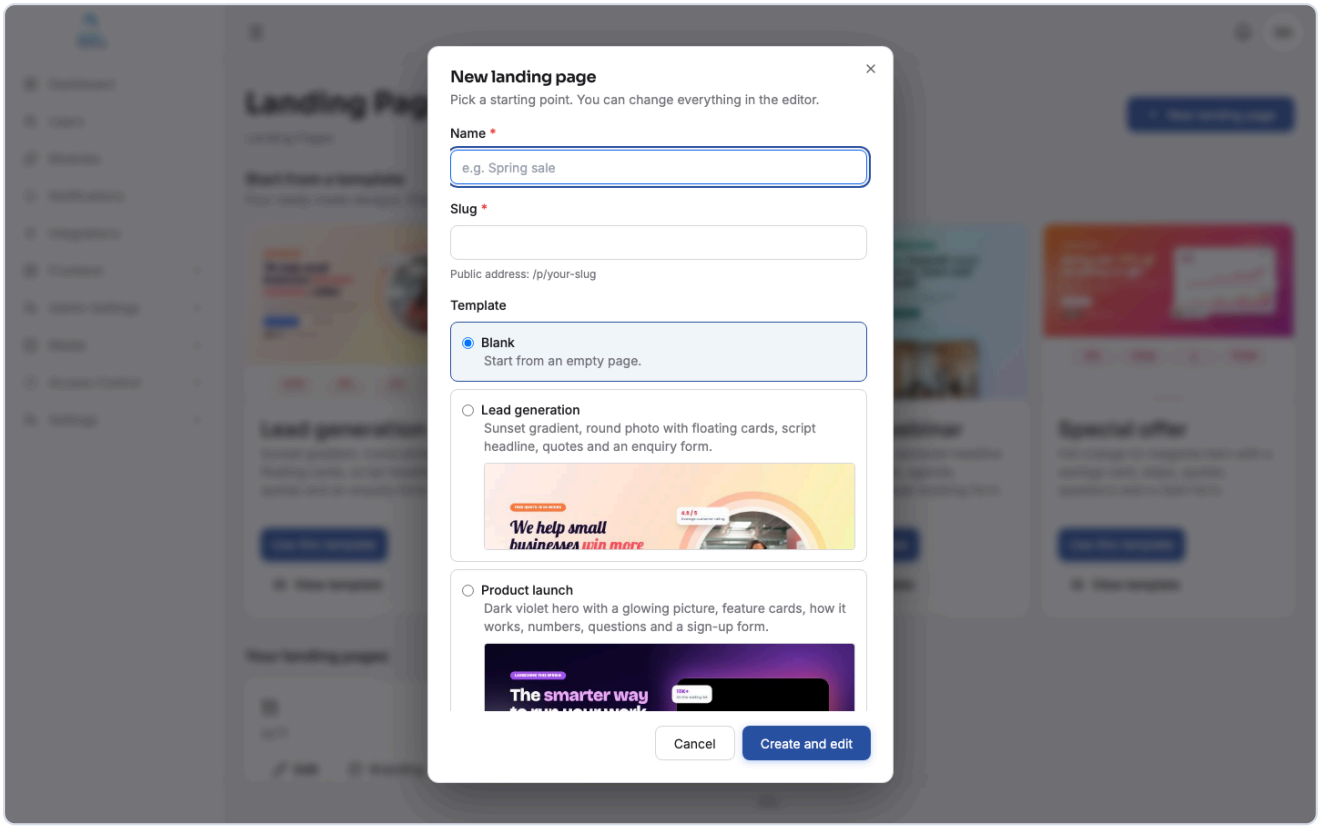
Under **Start from a template** there are four ready-made designs:

Template	Best for	Look
Lead generation	Collecting enquiries	Sunset gradient, round photo, quotes, enquiry form
Product launch	Launching a product	Dark violet, glowing picture, feature cards, sign-up form
Event or webinar	Bookings and seats	Aurora gradient, wide photo, agenda, speakers, booking form
Special offer	Sales and discounts	Orange to magenta, savings card, claim form

1. Click **View template** on a card to see the whole page before you choose.
2. Click **Use this template** on the one you like. (You can also click **New landing page** and choose **Blank**.)
3. Type a **Name** (for example "Spring sale"). The **Slug** is the public address: `/p/your-slug`.
4. Click **Create and edit**.



Landing Pages: four templates and your own pages.

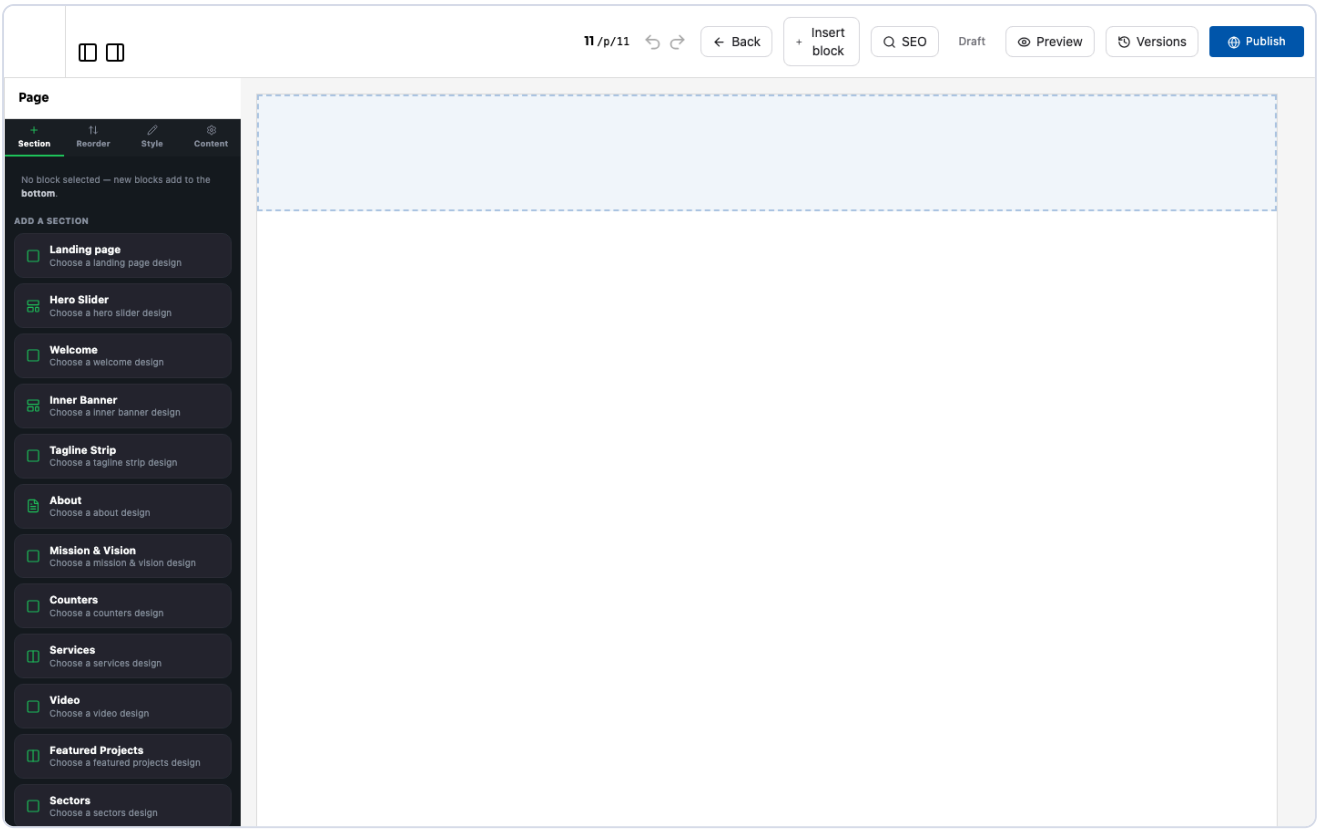


The New landing page dialog: name, slug and template.

Step 17. Edit the page

The editor opens. Click any text, picture or button to change it. In the left panel, **Landing page** lists the landing sections you can add. Many sections have a **Design 1 to 4** choice: numbers, benefits, about,

testimonials, FAQ and call to action. Switching a design keeps your content. Each section also has **Colours** and **Fonts** choices.



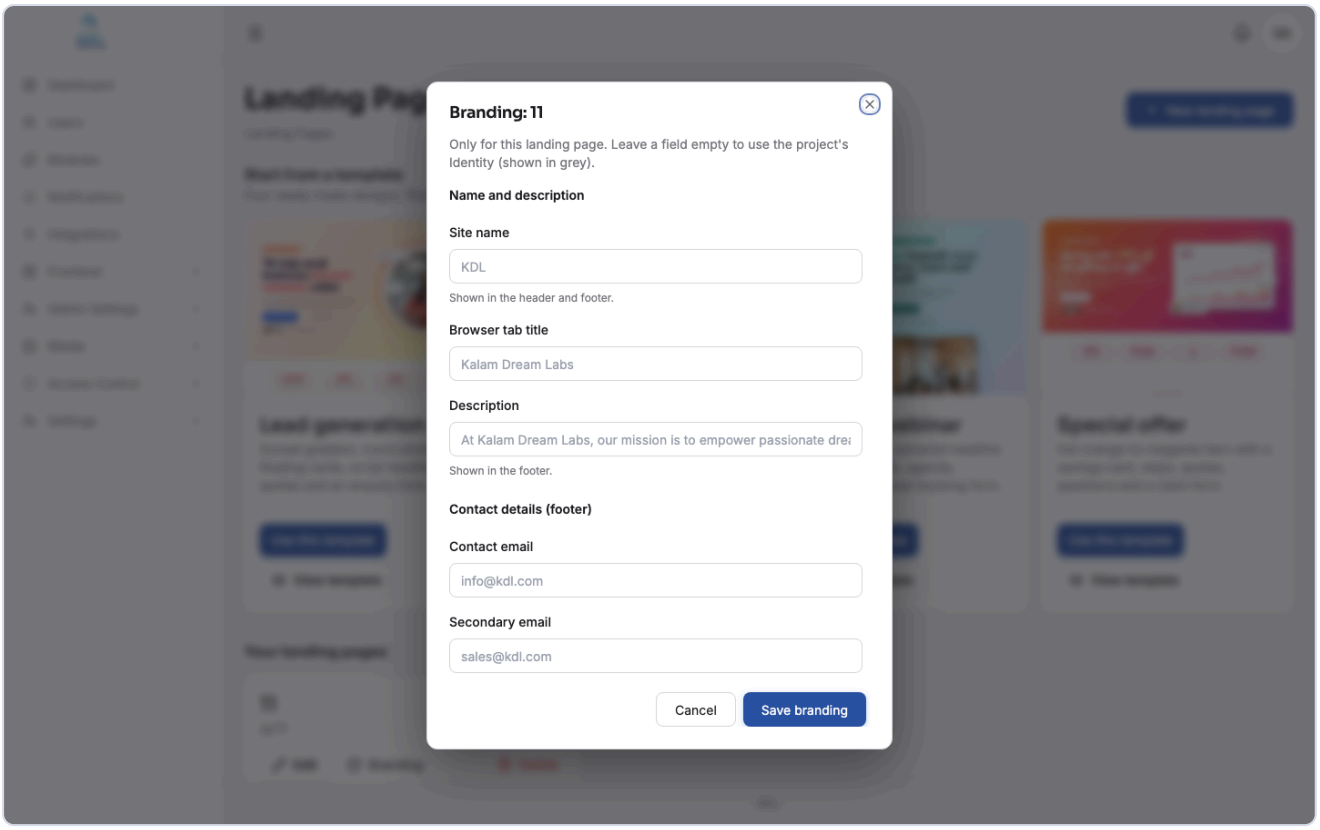
The editor: Insert block, SEO, Preview, Versions and Publish are across the top.

> **Good to know:** The editor top bar is: **Back**, **Insert block**, **SEO**, the status (**Draft**), **Preview**, **Versions** and **Publish**. Changes save as a draft by themselves.

Step 18. Check the branding for this page

Back on the Landing Pages list, click **Branding** on your page. Everything is optional: leave a field empty and the page uses your Identity (shown in grey).

Group	Fields
Name and description	Site name, browser tab title, description
Contact details (footer)	Email, secondary email, phone, secondary phone, address
Social links (footer)	Facebook, X, Instagram, LinkedIn, YouTube
Footer text	Copyright notice
Pictures	Logo for light and dark backgrounds, favicon



Branding: only for this landing page.

Step 19. Publish

> **Important:** A new landing page starts as **Draft**. Visitors get "404 no published page" at `/p/your-slug` until you publish it.

1. In the editor, click **Preview** to check the page on desktop, tablet and phone.
2. Click **Publish**. Fix any problem the checks list, or choose **Publish anyway**.
3. On the Landing Pages list the page now says **Published**. Click **View** to open it, or visit `http://localhost/p/your-slug`.
4. To take it down, open the editor and choose **Unpublish**. Your content is kept. **Versions** lists every publish and lets you restore an old one.

To remove a landing page for good, click **Delete** on its card and confirm.

The enquiry form

Each template comes with its own form, created together with the page. Answers are stored under **Forms**. You can edit the form fields there.

Everyday commands

I want to	Type this
Stop KDL OS (keeps my data)	`docker compose down`

Start it again	`docker compose up -d`
See what is running	`docker compose ps`
Update to the latest code	`git pull` then `docker compose up -d --build`
Forgot the admin password	`docker compose exec backend node scripts/reset-admin-password.js --email admin@kdl.com --password 'Admin@123'`

Important: `docker compose down -v` deletes **all your data**. Do not use it unless you want to start from zero.

If something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
"502 Bad Gateway"	Wait 1 or 2 minutes and refresh. KDL OS is still starting.
"Port is already in use"	Close the other program using it (for example a local website on port 80).
Build stops with "Killed"	Give Docker 8 GB of memory and run Step 4 again.
Login says wrong password	Did you run Step 5? Use `kdl-dev-seed-password` the first time.
"Account locked", or "Too many requests" while testing	Wait a minute and try again. If it continues: `docker compose restart backend`.
Color Palette, Brands or Pages says "Add your logo"	Open Admin Settings → Identity, upload your logo, then try again.
The Frontend group is missing from the sidebar	Open Modules and enable Frontend, or choose Website or Landing Pages at `/admin/settings/products`.
My landing page shows 404	It is still a Draft. Open the editor and click Publish.
The wizard keeps coming back	Answer it once. If you close it, it stays closed in that browser.

Quick checklist

- [ ] Cloned, `.env` created, `docker compose up -d --build` finished
- [ ] `backend` is healthy, admin user created
- [ ] Signed in and changed the password
- [ ] Wizard done: company name, **logo**, Website and Landing Pages turned on
- [ ] Frontend module shows Enabled, Frontend group is in the sidebar
- [ ] Web app: fonts, buttons, navigation, pages, layouts
- [ ] Web app pages published, site opens at http://localhost
- [ ] Landing page created from a template, branding checked
- [ ] Landing page published, opens at /p/your-slug